



Tube amps sound cool but not all of them look this cool!

less distortion. In comparison, solid-state amps have odd-order harmonics which make them sound harsh, along with a flat distortion across power levels that suddenly clips at higher levels. While technically this means the device signals distort less and their performance is accurate to their specification, in a musical context it makes them sound... nothing special (some say). What that means is, tube amps add their own colouration to the sound being emitted which may or may not be preferred by some people. On the other hand, solid state amps are focussed on giving true-to-the-source output. So, to some, tube amps may ‘sound’ better but they definitely don’t perform better than SS amps.

Myth #5 - The usefulness of monitor specs and reviews

Every consumer product has reviews, it’s a necessity with the proliferation of e-commerce. Things like graphics cards have specs like shader units and memory bandwidth, along with performance benchmarks like G3DMark and in-game framerates. With audio tech, things get a lot more subjective. Specs like frequency response, driver size and impedance can give you a general idea of the product but they are not at all helpful to get to know the quality of the sound. Some companies provide a complete sound signature, but even that is not enough. That is why you read reviews, and that is why we write them. We write about our hands-on experience with the product but even with such systems, there can be problems. This is due to the nature